[METRIC]

A-A-2779
December 15, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MARKER, TUBE TYPE, HIGHLIGHTER

This Commercial Item Description is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

This commercial item description covers tube type, chisel tipped (felt, fiber or porous plastic nib) markers for use in highlighting printed text.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

A. The tube type marker for highlighting shall be furnished with a non-replaceable felt, fiber or porous plastic chisel capillary feed tip, and cap.

B. The marker shall be furnished with ink of the following colors blue, red, green, yellow, or as specified in section 9 (Notes). The ink shall not have an objectionable odor.

C. The cap or body of the marker shall be colored to identify the color of ink.

D. The marker shall be legibly and permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark and other marking requirements (see section 7 and 9).

E. The marker shall be non-refillable and shall operate by capillary action. The tip shall be held within the marker by an absorbent material so that there is no free liquid within the marker. The marker barrel shall be made of metal or plastic or a combination of these materials, and constructed so that the ink will emerge only through the writing tip. The marker shall be equipped with a tight fitting plastic or metal protective cap to provide protection against evaporation and leakage of the ink.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7520

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F. The overall length of the marker shall be not less than 12.5 cm (5.00 inches) with cap in place.

G. The marker barrel shall be made of plastic or metal or a combination of these materials. The barrel diameter shall be not less than 1.0 cm, excluding tapered and recessed ends and not more than 2.5 cm.

H. The writing tip shall be of any material suitable for the intended purpose. The tip shall be permanently secured in position.

I. The items shall have a shelf life of one year after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling and pass the uniform writing test (see section 3B).

J. The workmanship of the marker shall be free from defects or imperfections of manufacture which may affect their durability, appearance or serviceability or present a hazard to the user. The surface of the marker shall be of uniform appearance and shall be free from rough or sharp edges, burrs, blisters, scratches and other defects.

2. PERFORMANCE CHARACTERISTICS

A. Drying Time - Lines shall dry within 5 seconds on bond paper. There shall be no smearing or smudging.

B. Lines drawn on bond paper shall be solid and of uniform density when tested in accordance with section 3B.

C. When the marker is tested in accordance with section 3C, there shall be no evidence of leakage. The cap and barrel of the marker shall show no damage and the writing tip shall show no signs of permanent loosening.

D. The marker shall produce a continuous line within 4 strokes after testing in accordance with section 3A.

E. The cap shall be tight fitting but shall be easily removable without tools and shall prevent loss of ink by evaporation or leakage.

F. The tip shall be firm within the marker to permit good control when highlighting.

G. The marker shall have a write-out of 340 Meters (minimum) when tested on an Anja W-10B, K & L Machine Corporation Broad tip marker tester or equal.

3. TEST METHODS

A. Startability - Place three unused markers in the vertical position with the caps removed and the tips up. After an

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intervals of 30 minutes, draw the tip repeatedly across a sheet of plain bond paper at a normal rate, with a normal writing pressure, until a continuous 200 mm line is obtained.

B. Uniform Writing - Draw five lines on bond paper over printed or typed text. Examine the lines for uniformity of intensity. The lines shall highlight the text without obscuring the text.

C. Impact Resistance - Drop three capped markers 3 times each on a wooden floor from a height of 135 cm, first on the end remote from the tip, second on the side, and third on the cap. Examine the body and cap for cracks and leakage, and the tip for loosening and leakage. Draw a few sharp turns, reversals and circles, and examine the tip for signs of loosening.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

5. HAZARDOUS MATERIAL REQUIREMENTS.

A. Toxicity. Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the inks conforms to the above requirements.

B. Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

C. Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

6. QUALITY ASSURANCE REQUIREMENTS.

A. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 9), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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B. Lot definition. Each lot of markers shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall be expressed in markers manufactured from the same materials, at essentially the same time.

C. Examination of the end item for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one marker. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any marker containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

Examine	Defects
Workmanship	See Workmanship paragraph
Material	Not as specified

D. Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one marker. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any marker containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

Examine	Defects
Diameter	Not as specified
Length	Not as specified

E. Sampling of end items for performance tests. Sampling for performance testing shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one marker. A random sample from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

Examine	Defects
Tests	Does not comply

F. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section 7.

7. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

Unless otherwise specified preparation for delivery shall conform to normal commercial practice. All packages shall be marked to show month and year of manufacture (date of marker assembly).

A. Packaging, and packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see section 9). The normal commercial number of unit packages shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box used commercially for this item. The complete pack shall be in

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compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification. The weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 65 lbs.

B. Marking. Marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see section 9).

1. For Shipment To Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See section 9).

2. For Shipment To Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See section 9).

3. Additional marking. The unit and shipping containers shall include the date of manufacture and the date of reinspection (12 months after the date of manufacture) and the shipping containers, in addition, shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222, Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

8. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

A. Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations:

Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials

16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

B. National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification - Item 222

Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W. Washington, D.C., 20036.

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C. Uniform Classification Committee Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification - Rule 41

Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

D. Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions:

Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and Specification and Consumer Information Distribution Section, Building 197, Washington Navy Yard, Washington DC 20407.

Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)

FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

E. Military Standards:

Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Dept. Bldg. 4D 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

9. NOTES.

Ordering information. Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall indicate color of ink
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing,

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and any special marking for shipment, if other than required (See section 7).

E. Identification marking, if other than required.
F. If bar code marking is required.
G. MSDS's required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.
H. Purchasers shall specify palletization , if required.
I. Purchasers shall specify additional testing if required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

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